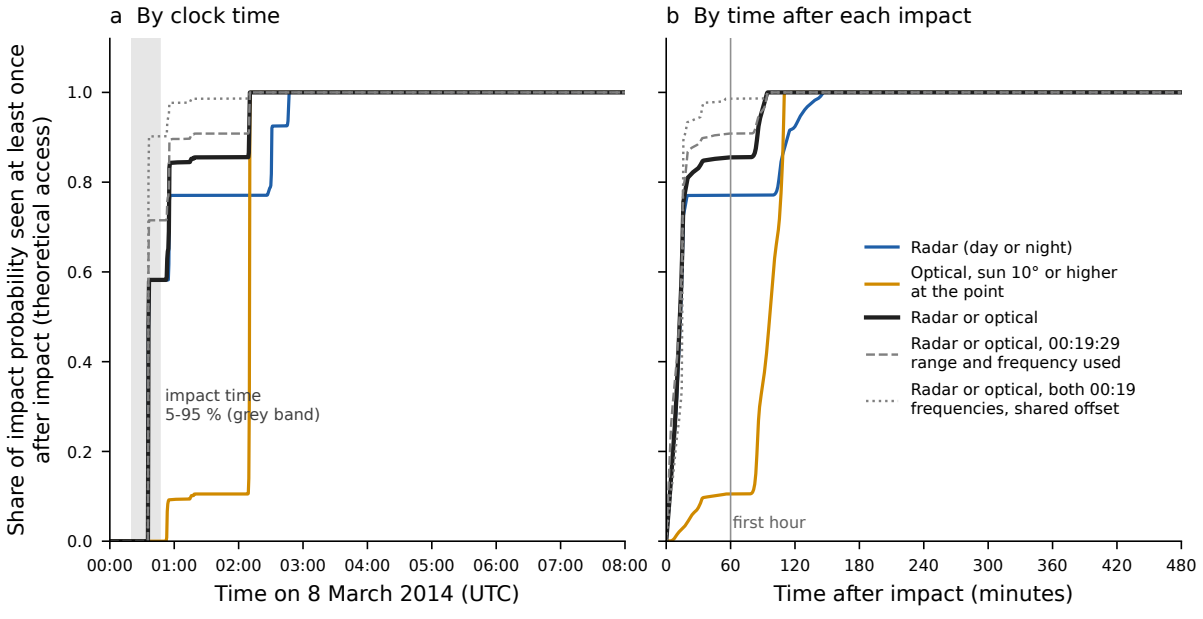
Satellites that could have imaged the impact point after impact, 8 March 2014



(i) The lines show how much of the impact probability had a satellite pass that could point at it after the impact. This is a theoretical upper limit. It does not show that an image was taken. Radar sees at night and through cloud. Optical needs daylight.

(ii) Impact sample: end-of-flight run J, waypoints family only (core P = 0.9982), 24 seeds, 1.5 M draws by two-stage resampling of the rebuilt flight-posterior weights; 00:19 option '00:19 data not used' (D0, competing log-on causes q = 1/3, other cause silent), dashed and dotted lines D2 and D4. Passes: 89 satellites with March 2014 element sets (SGP4, 5 s); 19 classified satellites without element sets excluded. A pass counts when its zero-Doppler line crosses the point inside the access band (SAR near-far incidence on allowed side; optical max off-nadir + half swath, sun >= 10 deg at the point). One SAR scene covers only one beam of the band; sensor tasking unknown. Median first access after impact 13 min (D0).